

RED BAIL SOURCE DECIDES TO QUIT

Civil Rights Congress Will Dissolve With 19 Branches, Ending Stormy Career

The Civil Rights Congress, purveyor of bail for convicted Communist leaders, announced yesterday that it had decided to liquidate itself.

Its executive secretary, William L. Patterson, will wind up the affairs of the national organization and its chapters in nineteen cities over the country.

The congress, which was founded in 1949, has been constantly in hot water since 1951 when four top Communist leaders jumped \$80,000 combined bail posted by its bail fund. The four were among eleven convicted in 1949 of conspiracy to teach and advocate overthrow of the Government by force and violence.

Four trustees of the congress' bail fund were jailed for contempt of court in 1951 after they had refused to aid Federal authorities in their search for the fugitives. The jailed trustees included Frederick Vanderbilt Field, wealthy backer of left-wing causes, and Dashiell Hammett, mystery story writer.

State and Federal investigations of the congress have continued in the last five years. The State Banking Department made a nine-month inquiry that resulted in the bail fund's remaining \$717,000 in assets being deposited with the State Supreme Court in 1952 at the request of Nathaniel L. Goldstein, then State Attorney General.

After the inauguration of President Eisenhower in 1953 the congress was one of the first twelve organizations that Attorney General Herbert Brownell Jr. cited as Communist fronts.

In 1954 Mr. Patterson was jailed for contempt of court for failing to produce books and records of his organization for examination by the Internal Revenue Service.

After an investigation of philanthropic rackets in New York State, State Senator Edward P. Larkin, chairman of a joint legislative committee, charged in February, 1955, that the congress had diverted to subversive uses large sums ostensibly collected for worthy causes.

Last August President Eisenhower signed an Executive order authorizing the House Committee on Un-American Activities to examine the tax returns of the organization and other Communist fronts to uncover "secret angels" of the Communist party.

The final blow came last month when an examiner of the Subversive Activities Control Board ruled after hearings that the congress must register with the Attorney General as a subversive organization.

The examiner, David D. Codaire, said the congress had been "conceived by the Kremlin" and had raised more than \$1,000,000 in bail for Communist leaders, plus hundreds of thousands of dollars for defense of Communist conspirators.